Galway Community College

Healthy Eating Policy

Adopted Copy February 2016

This policy has been prepared in consultation with Parents, Students, Staff, the Board of Management and the Galway Roscommon Education Training Board (GRETB).

Ratified By B.O.M. 1st Feb 2016

Ratified By GRETB

Healthy Eating Policy

Introductory statement

This policy was formulated after a survey was carried out among the staff and students in Galway Community College The focus of this policy is to support parents, staff and students in relation to healthy eating habits. Addressing the obesity issue in Ireland requires a multi-faceted approach that involves the development of knowledge, skills and attitudes that influence behaviour on food selection, consumption and also engagement in appropriate levels of physical activity.

Rationale

This policy has been developed to promote health in Galway Community College. Global research indicates a strong link between student diet and school performance. A healthy diet promotes concentration, lessens hyperactivity and reduces health risks in later life. As part of Social, Personal and Health Education (S.P.H.E.), Physical Education (P.E.), Science and Home Economics, students are encouraged to become more aware of the need for healthy food and drinks at lunch time and the participation in physical exercise.

Aims

The aims of the policy are to:

- To promote healthy eating habits and a healthy body image among school-going children and young people
- Promote the health of the student and provide a foundation for healthy living.
- Enable the student to appreciate the importance of good nutrition for growing, developing and staying healthy.
- Enable the student to accept some personal responsibility for making wise food choices and adopting a healthy balanced diet.

Objectives:

- To help students, staff and parents make healthy food choices
- To improve the student's concentration and energy levels
- To develop an awareness of nutrition i.e. the ingredients found in food.

Healthy Lunches

Lunch is an important meal for school students. It should provide one third of their recommended daily allowance of nutrients without being high in fat, sugar or salt. It should also provide dietary fibre (roughage). The school canteen provides healthy meals for break and lunch for students to avail of. These lunches incorporate a good variety of nutrients and are all health promoting foods. If students bring in their own lunch it must follow the healthy eating policy guidelines. A heathy lunch should include a variety of the following:

1. Wholegrain breads or cereals
2. Fruit and vegetables
3. Milk, cheese and yoghurt
4. Meat, chicken, fish (tinned salmon, tuna) or alternatives

For example, a healthy lunch may include a ham, cheese or tuna salad sandwich, yoghurt, a piece of fruit and a drink of water, milk or fruit juice. Galway Community College provides these lunches for free to all our students and students should be encouraged to avail of this facility.

Rules For Healthy Eating Policy

- The following foods are **not** permitted; chewing gum, bars, crisps, sweets, biscuits, cakes and buns.
- Energy Drinks, Fizzy Drinks are not permitted on the premises
- No eating during Class time

Students will be educated on the following healthy eating choices and healthy eating should be actively promoted by all staff and parents.

Healthy Lunchbox Ideas & Recipes

Snacks:

Try...whole-meal muffins, raisins, whole-meal scones, flapjacks, raw vegetables, fruit, seeds, dried fruit, natural yoghurts, wholegrain crackers or brown bread

Drinks:

Gulp down...water, unsweetened fruit juices, milkshakes, vegetable juices, or smoothies

High fibre Carbohydrates:

What about...whole-grain breads, rolls, bagels, wraps, oatcakes, crackers, pasta, rice or rice cakes. Fillings could include: cheese, tuna, salmon, hummus, cold meats, lettuce, cucumber, tomato, onion, peppers, or salad.

Fruit:

Munch on...apple, orange, banana, grape, pear, plum, kiwi, melon, grapefruit and pineapple.

Raw Vegetables:

Crunch on...carrots, peppers, cucumber, broccoli, tomatoes, sweetcorn and many more.

If students bring prohibited food or drink into school the item will be confiscated.

N.B.: Parents/guardians of any student with a medical condition which requires a special diet should contact the school.

Action plan:

The Policy is adopted by the Parents, Students Council, Teachers Principal, BOM, School Cafe Personnel,

The policy is made visible in writing and adopted in practice with the school.

Action	People involved	Timeframe
School Health Promotion Week	Students, staff and parents	Feb/March for 1 week
Lunchtime Club	Students, staff	Currently Running
Posters displayed around the school promoting positive health	Students and staff	
Childline Cheerio's Breakfast Morning	Students and Home Economic teachers	
Breakfast Club		
Canteen healthy eating posters	Canteen staff	
Bodywhys – Healthy Eating Disorders Ireland	Home Economics students and staff	
Art competition for health promoting symbol	Students and art staff	
Fresh fruit juice and smoothies Healthy snacks demo	PLC Students and Mainstream Home EC Staff	GCurrently Runningirls Club
Community dietician	PLC Students and MAinstream	Health Promotion Week
Food pyramid poster creation	Students and health promotion team /sphe staff	– during their SPHE class
Water Fountains	Management	
Implementing no fizzy drinks and healthy eating policy	Management and all staff	